Diabetes Remedy

The aerial parts of *Galega officinalis* (Fabaceae) contains Metformin (dimethyl biguanide). It is now reputed to be the most widely prescribed agent in the treatment of diabetes all over the world.



The seeds of *Abrus precatorius* are used in necklaces and rosaries, but are extremely poisonous and can be fatal if ingested.



The attractive seeds of *Adenanthera pavonina* (Family: Caesalpiniaceae) have been used as units of weight for the measures of gold throughout India.



5.13.2 Family: Apocynaceae (milk weed family) (including Asclepiadaceae)



Systematic position

APG classification		Bentham and Hooker classification	
Kingdom	Plantae	Kingdom	Plantae
Clade	Angiosperms	Class	Dicotyledonae
Clade	Eudicots	Sub-class	Gamopetalae
Clade	Asterides	Series	Bicarpellatae
Order	Gentianales	Order	Gentianales
Family	Apocynaceae	Family	Apocynaceae

General Characters

Distribution:

This family is represented by 345 genera, 4,675 species. Mostly tropical and subtropical whereas a few species found in temperate region.

Habit: Herb (*Catharanthus)*, shrub, (*Nerium)*, tree (*Alstonia*), woody twiner (*Allamanda*) succulent, (*Adenium*) with milky sap in laticiferous vessels.

Root: Branched tap root system

Stem: The stems are succulent in some taxa (*Stapelia, caralluma*), usually erect, branched solid, glabrous, rarely tube like and thick.

Leaves: Simple, entire, rarely stipulate (*Tabernae montana*) exstipulate, opposite decusate (*Calotropis*) or alternate (*Thevetia*) or ternate (Nerium), .

Inflorescence: A Panicle, dichasial cyme, often umbelliform in (Asclepiadoids) or raceme, or axillary cluster of two flowers each (*Catharanthus*).

Flowers: Bracteate, bracteolate, pedicellate, complete, bisexual, actinomorphic, zygomorphic in (*Ceropegia)* heterochlamydeous, pentamerous, hypogynous but rarely perigynous or epigynous



Ceropegia spp

Calyx: Sepals 5, synsepalous valvate or quincuncial (*Thevetia*), odd sepal posterior.

Corolla: Petals 5, sympetalous united into a tube, salver or funnel shaped; twisted or rarely valvate, often hairy within or contain some corona like out growths at the mouth of the corolla tube.

Androecium: Stamens 5, alternipetalous, often epipetalous, In *Asclepiadoids* the stamens are connate to the styles to form a

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